



Tips & Tricks



How to split the files

The following is an example of how to use the *split* command on a 600MB *image.iso* file:

```
split -b 200m image.iso
```

It will generate three files, namely xaa, xab and xac, of 200MB each. Afterwards you can use the *cat* command to combine the three to get back the original file, as follows:

```
cat xaa* > new-image.iso
```

—Remin, remin13@gmail.com



Interface devices fail to start up at boot time

Open the network card configuration script (it could be */etc/sysconfig/network/ifcfg-ethX* or */etc/sysconfig/network-scripts/ifcfg-ethX*, depending on the distro) in a text editor and add the following line:

```
STARTMODE=auto
```

To manually start it up:

Use */sbin/ifup* and */sbin/ifdown* to start and stop the network interface.

—Dheep Surendran, bobby_dheep@yahoo.com



Lost Bash history

If you have a terminal open in which you're executing certain commands, then open another one and use that for a while. You'll notice this new terminal doesn't remember any of the commands typed in the first one.

In addition, closing the first terminal, and then the

second will overwrite any of the commands typed in the first terminal. This happens because Bash history is only saved when you close the terminal, not after each command. To fix this, add the following lines to your *~/.bashrc* file:

```
shopt -s histappend  
PROMPT_COMMAND='history -a'
```

This will make Bash append an entry in its history after the execution of every command.

—Govindarajulu, govind.rajalu@gmail.com



Prevent users from changing their passwords

Usually */usr/bin/passwd* has the following SUID permission:

```
-r-s--x--x 1 root root 19348 Sep 7 2004 /usr/bin/passwd
```

The numerical value of the file permission translates to 4411.

When a SUID file is executed, the process that runs it is granted access to system resources based on the user who owns the file and not the user who created the process.

So, we need to remove the SUID for that command, so that normal users are denied the privileges of updating the file:

```
chmod u-s /usr/bin/passwd
```

...or:

```
chmod 511 /usr/bin/passwd
```

—Govindarajulu, govind.rajalu@gmail.com